



An Overwatch-themed anime made by fan

After creating a short-tribute for D.Va in Overwatch back in 2016, Korean blogger Glayer has finished a longer version. <http://digit.in/OvrwtchAnme>



Jurassic World Evolution

First visuals termed as in-game footage from the upcoming simulator game Jurassic World: Evolution revealed. <http://digit.in/JWEvoltn>

camera or processing power. Android has a more extensive selection of apps and is more customizable, but Android flagships are still not outselling iPhones. Android flagships lack software support or a version of Android built for the hardware (though Google did prove what hardware and software made for each other can do with its Pixel devices). Also, because Android manufacturers do not support their phone's software for more than two years, there is no incentive for them to make another Nokia 3310. Project Treble is all about improving the software experience for the customer with fast software updates.

Project Treble will change the dynamics of the mobile space. Android flagships will finally be able to meet or better the standards set by the iPhone, and this will provide some extremely compelling options for the customer. There won't be any inherent advantage of owning an iPhone. Android flagships often undercut the iPhone when it comes to price yet the iPhone sells more than Android flagships. Project Treble will lead to Android being more competitive when it comes to the flagship segment.

PROJECT TREBLE CAN MAKE YOU MORE MONEY

Project Treble will even have an impact on market economics. Android phones do not have high resale value. Resale value is directly proportional to how long a manufacturer supports a device. Project Treble will make it easier for manufacturers to update their devices and this will encourage them to support their devices for more than two years. iPhones are the gold standard for flagship phones when it comes to after-sales software experience. Even a \$999 iPhone will sell like hot cake because people believe that their phone will receive software updates for years to come. Android flagships, including Nexus devices, have not been able to earn the trust of their customers when it comes to software updates and Project Treble wants to change that.

Project Treble will impact budget phones too. Manufacturers, especially those who use a stock launcher, will be able to support budget segment devices for more than the one major software update they do right now. There is no hurdle between a software update and a manufacturer delivering it to the end user.

Even Google recognizes the importance of providing software updates for more than two years with its new Pixel 2 and Pixel 2 XL both of which will receive feature updates for three years. Consider two last generation flagships on Amazon India. LG G5 is selling for ₹24,999 whereas iPhone 7 is going for ₹38,999. That is a difference of ₹14,000 between two devices with the similar amount of features. Apple will support the iPhone for more than four years whereas LG will stop supporting the G5 after only two years if history is to repeat itself.

BACK END CHANGES WITH PROJECT TREBLE

To manufacture an Android device, a manufacturer has to comply with the Android Compatibility Definition Document (CDD) and pass the Compatibility Test Suite (CTS). CDD and CTS ensure that developers can make apps for all Android devices using a standard set of tools. The developer does not have to worry about if the application will work on one phone and not on another.

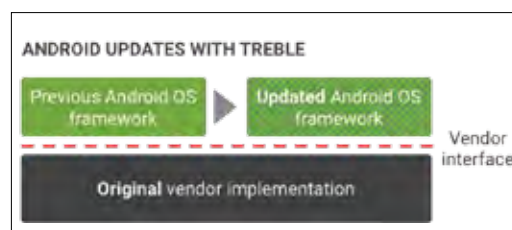
Project Treble is trying to simplify the update process for manufacturers by using the core idea behind CDD and CTS. A manufacturer will be able to push new Android versions without waiting for the silicon manufacturer to update the vendor implementation. Vendor implementation makes sure that devices follow a particular template when it comes to the device drivers and other essential device software. To ensure compatibility, Android will use Vendor Test Suite (VTS), similar to

CTS. By making it easier and less expensive to update devices, Android is encouraging manufacturers to support their devices for more than two years (or in case of a budget segment devices, release at least one software update).

Project Treble is a giant leap for Android. It is not about improving how Android looks but is all about improving how Android feels, or even more importantly, how well it works over the years. If a mobile device is



How Android updates are released now



How Android will be released after Project Treble

supported for more than two years, it usually feels more fluid and fast because of developments in the efficiency of software powering the device.

Project Treble is removing the disconnect that exists between Android flagships and customers. Manufacturers want customers to buy new phones regularly, while the customer wants long-term support. Project Treble will remove the obstacles in the path for updates to ensure that the user wins. Manufacturers can no longer use the excuse of time-consuming software updates. Google has recognized the need for long-term software support. Project Treble is trying to be the messiah of the Android world. Android and updates don't go hand in hand, as people say and Project Treble is out there to prove them wrong. We just hope that this ability itself arrives on most Android phones soon enough. Until then, good old updates it is.